

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Backroads hiring team,

I am applying for the Hotel Operations Assistant role as a deliberate move into active travel. From Emeryville, I can bring three years of SOW documentation, multi-system data work, and deadline-sensitive client delivery to Backroads' Berkeley Hotel Operations team.

Backroads' recent expansion of Casual Hotels and clearer Luxury Hotels naming shows how carefully lodging must be represented across trips and guest communications. Supporting more than 850 hotel and ship partners with accurate contract and property data is detailed behind-the-scenes work with a direct effect on the guest experience, which is exactly why I am applying.

My experience maps directly to the team's day-to-day needs:

- **Document quality:** I write SOWs and milestone-gated delivery plans that turn stakeholder requirements into clear scope, responsibilities, and acceptance criteria. I would bring that same care to reviewing hotel contract documents.
- **Multi-system accuracy:** I modernized a data-ingestion pipeline, increasing throughput 99.8% in four months while cutting cost 86%. That work required accurate movement of information across source and destination systems.
- **Reporting and collaboration:** At IBM, I built Tableau and Cognos reports for operating teams and executives, used stakeholder sessions to clarify reporting needs, and documented changes for colleagues.

The hands-on scope of this role is part of what attracts me. I want to apply my systems discipline where accurate behind-the-scenes work improves active travel. Living aboard a sailboat on the San Francisco Bay, completing EMT certification and AIARE 1 training, and co-building an outdoor-education trip-planning capstone have made that direction concrete. I would bring sustained care to reviewing documents, auditing hotel data, learning Backroads' systems, and supporting contract owners.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my operational data experience can support the Hotel Operations team.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker